

Perturbative treatment of non-local operators in quantum Monte Carlo

Ryan Curry

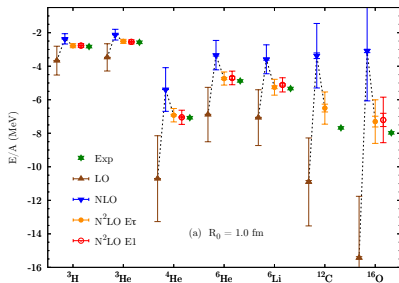
University of Guelph &
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2025-02-27

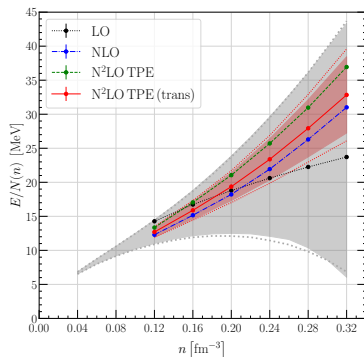
*2025 Workshop on Progress in Ab Initio Nuclear Theory
TRIUMF, Vancouver*

Motivation - Pushing AFDMC to N³LO

- Our current QMC calculations of light nuclei and neutron matter EOS include terms only up to N²LO
- There is a nonlocal “obstacle” to be dealt with first



D. Lonardoni, S. Gandolfi, J.E. Lynn, *et. al*
Phys. Rev. C **97** (2018)



I. Tews, R. Somasundaram, *et. al*
arXiv:2407.08979 (2024)

Quantum Monte Carlo

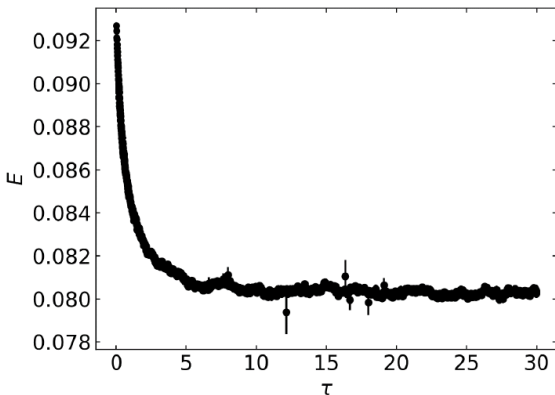
Schrodinger equation in imaginary time
$$-\frac{\partial}{\partial \tau} \Psi = \left(-\frac{\hbar}{2m} \nabla^2 + V \right) \Psi$$

$$\psi(\tau) = e^{-(H-E_T)\tau} \psi_T$$

$$\psi(\tau) = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i e^{-(E_i-E_T)\tau} \psi_i$$

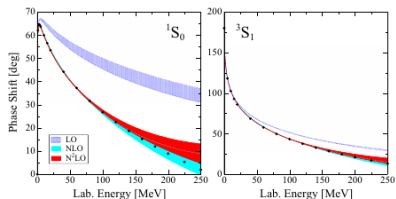
$$\psi(\tau) = a_0 \psi_0 \quad \lim_{\tau \rightarrow \infty}$$

“Projects” out the
ground-state energy and
wavefunction



Local Chiral EFT

- QMC needs a local coordinate space interaction
- Use only half of the operators in calculation
- Recover the rest through anti-symmetrization



- $q \rightarrow r$ local
- $k \rightarrow \nabla$ non-local

A. Gezerlis, I. Tews, E. Epelbaum, S. Gandolfi, K. Hebeler, A. Nogga, and A. Schwenk, Phys. Rev. Lett. **111**, 032501 (2013)

$$V^{(0)} = \alpha_1 + \alpha_2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \alpha_3 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \alpha_4 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2$$

$$\begin{aligned} V_{\text{cont}}^{(2)} = & \gamma_1 q^2 + \gamma_2 q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \gamma_3 q^2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_4 q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_5 k^2 + \gamma_6 k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \gamma_7 k^2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_8 k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_9 (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2)(q \times k) \\ & + \gamma_{10} (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2)(q \times k) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_{11} (\sigma_1 \cdot q)(\sigma_2 \cdot q) \\ & + \gamma_{12} (\sigma_1 \cdot q)(\sigma_2 \cdot q) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\ & + \gamma_{13} (\sigma_1 \cdot k)(\sigma_2 \cdot k) \\ & + \gamma_{14} (\sigma_1 \cdot k)(\sigma_2 \cdot k) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \end{aligned}$$

Trouble on the horizon ...

- 30 new contact operators at N³LO
- Cannot avoid non-local operators

$$\begin{aligned}
 V_{\text{cont}}^{(4)} = & \text{(green)} \alpha_1 q^4 + \text{(green)} \alpha_2 q^4 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \text{(green)} \alpha_3 q^4 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \text{(green)} \alpha_4 q^4 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \alpha_5 k^4 + \alpha_6 k^4 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \alpha_7 k^4 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \alpha_8 k^4 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \alpha_9 q^2 k^2 + \alpha_{10} q^2 k^2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \alpha_{11} q^2 k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \alpha_{12} q^2 k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \text{(orange)} \alpha_{13} (q \times k)^2 + \text{(orange)} \alpha_{14} (q \times k)^2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \alpha_{15} (q \times k)^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 + \alpha_{16} (q \times k)^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \text{(green)} \frac{i}{2} \alpha_{17} q^2 (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2) \cdot (q \times k) + \text{(green)} \frac{i}{2} \alpha_{18} q^2 (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2) \cdot (q \times k) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \frac{i}{2} \alpha_{19} k^2 (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2) \cdot (q \times k) + \frac{i}{2} \alpha_{20} k^2 (\sigma_1 + \sigma_2) \cdot (q \times k) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \text{(green)} \alpha_{21} q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot q \sigma_2 \cdot q + \text{(green)} \alpha_{22} q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot q \sigma_2 \cdot q \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \text{(orange)} \alpha_{23} k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot q \sigma_2 \cdot q + \alpha_{24} k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot q \sigma_2 \cdot q \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \alpha_{25} q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot k \sigma_2 \cdot k + \alpha_{26} q^2 \sigma_1 \cdot k \sigma_2 \cdot k \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 + \alpha_{27} k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot k \sigma_2 \cdot k + \alpha_{28} k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot k \sigma_2 \cdot k \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 \\
 & + \text{(orange)} \alpha_{29} \sigma_1 \cdot (q \times k) \sigma_2 \cdot (q \times k) + \alpha_{30} \sigma_1 \cdot (q \times k) \sigma_2 \cdot (q \times k) \tau_1 \cdot \tau_2 .
 \end{aligned}$$

- Need develop a way to self consistently treat non-local operators perturbatively

The problem?

First- and Second-order Corrections

$$E_0^{(1)} = \langle \psi_0 | V' | \psi_0 \rangle$$

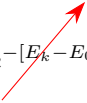
$$E_0^{(2)} = - \sum_{k \neq 0}^{\infty} \frac{|\langle \psi_0 | V' | \psi_k \rangle|^2}{E_k - E_0}$$

The problem?

$$\lim_{\tau \rightarrow \infty} \psi(\tau) = \lim_{\tau \rightarrow \infty} e^{-(H-E_T)\tau} \psi_T \propto \psi_0 \longrightarrow E_0$$

A solution - In very brief

$$I(\mathcal{T}) = \int_0^{\mathcal{T}} d\tau \langle \psi_0 | V' e^{-[H_0 - E_0]\tau} V' | \psi_0 \rangle$$

$$I(\mathcal{T}) = (E_0^{(1)})^2 \mathcal{T} - \sum_{k \neq 0}^{\infty} \frac{|\langle \psi_k | V' | \psi_0 \rangle|^2}{E_k - E_0} [e^{-[E_k - E_0]\mathcal{T}} - 1]$$


$$I(\mathcal{T} \rightarrow \infty) = (E_0^{(1)})^2 \mathcal{T} - E_0^{(2)}$$

Non-Local Operators

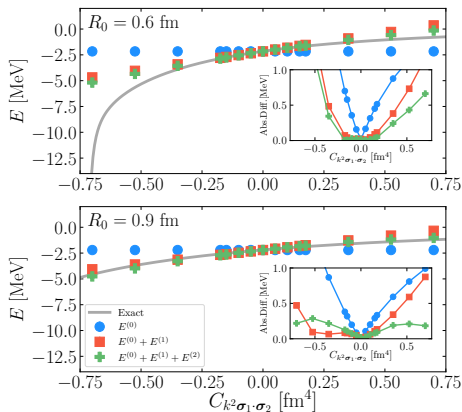
- Non-local operators cannot be avoided at higher chiral orders.
- Non-local operators cannot easily be included in imaginary time propagator
- Let's replace a local operator at NLO with a non-local equivalent and treat perturbatively
- $q \rightarrow r$ local
- $k \rightarrow \nabla$ non-local

$$V^{(0)} = \alpha_1 + \alpha_2 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 + \alpha_3 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 + \alpha_4 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2$$

$$\begin{aligned} V_{\text{cont}}^{(2)} = & \gamma_1 q^2 + \gamma_2 q^2 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 + \gamma_3 q^2 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_4 q^2 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_5 k^2 + \gamma_6 k^2 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 + \gamma_7 k^2 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_8 k^2 \boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_9 (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2)(\boldsymbol{q} \times \boldsymbol{k}) \\ & + \gamma_{10} (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2)(\boldsymbol{q} \times \boldsymbol{k}) \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_{11} (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{q})(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \cdot \boldsymbol{q}) \\ & + \gamma_{12} (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{q})(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \cdot \boldsymbol{q}) \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \\ & + \gamma_{13} (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{k})(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \cdot \boldsymbol{k}) \\ & + \gamma_{14} (\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{k})(\boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 \cdot \boldsymbol{k}) \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \end{aligned}$$

Deuteron with non-local operator

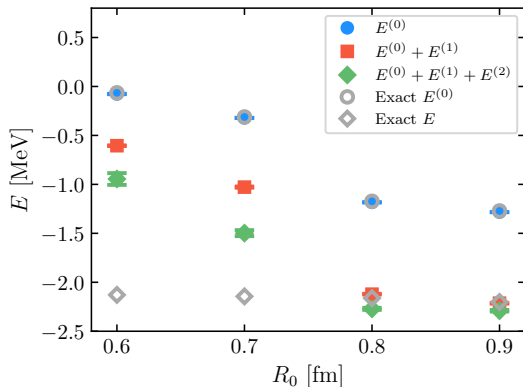
$$k^2 \longrightarrow \left[-\frac{1}{4}(\nabla^2 \delta_{R_0} \psi(\mathbf{r}) - \frac{1}{r} \frac{\partial \delta_{R_0}}{\partial r} (\mathbf{r} \cdot \nabla \psi(\mathbf{r})) - \delta_{R_0} \nabla^2 \psi(\mathbf{r}) \right]$$



- Non-local operator not included in fit to phase shifts
- $k^2 \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2$ included perturbatively for two cutoffs
- Compare against exact Lippmann-Schwinger solution

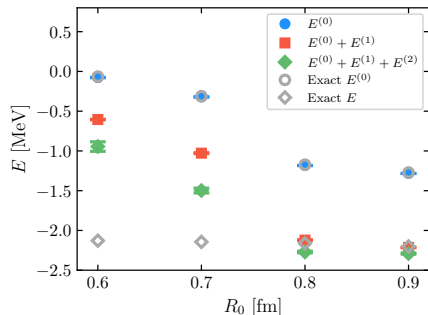
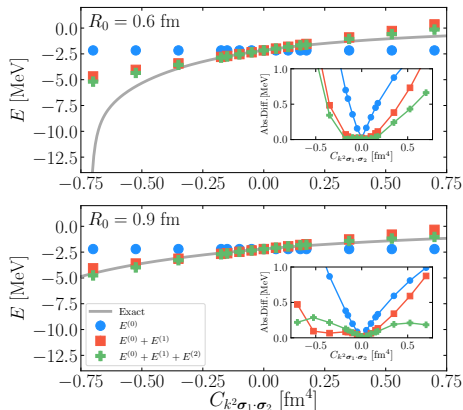
A more realistic test case

- Non-local operator included in fit to phase shifts



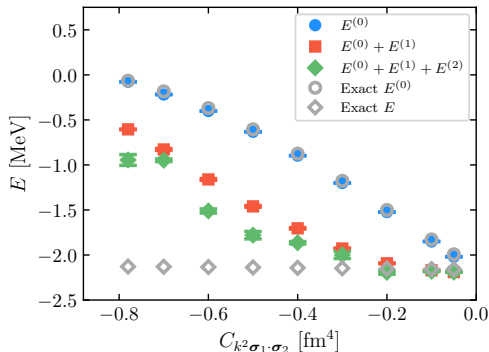
- Full range of coordinate space cutoffs
- Issues with perturbativeness at harder cutoffs

Wait a minute...



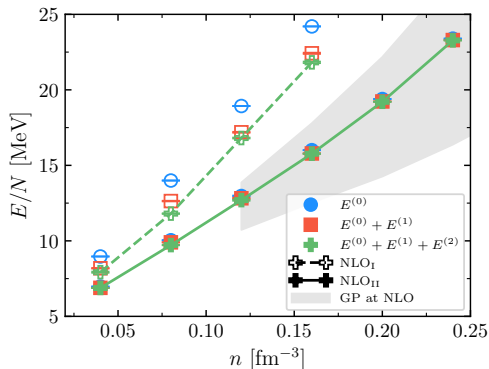
Can we take inspiration from the first case, and improve on the hard cutoff?

Constraining the non-local operator



- Non-local operator included in fit to phase shifts
- Create a series of NLO interactions with a variable non-local LEC
- Clear region where perturbation theory is sufficient!

Neutron Matter



- Use constrained NLO interaction for calculation of neutron matter EOS (see poster for details)
- Clear improvement from constraining the non-local operator
- Able to include non-local operators perturbatively even for hard cutoff interactions!

R. Curry, R. Somasundaram, S. Gandolfi, A. Gezerlis, and I. Tews, Phys. Rev. C, **111**, 015801 (2025)

I. Tews, R. Somasundaram, *et. al* arXiv:2407.08979

Acknowledgements

Collaborators:

- Alex Gezerlis (Guelph)
- Ingo Tews (LANL)
- Stefano Gandolfi (LANL)
- Rahul Somasundaram (LANL, SU)
- Kevin Schmidt (ASU)
- Joel Lynn (Darmstadt)

Funding / Computational Resources:

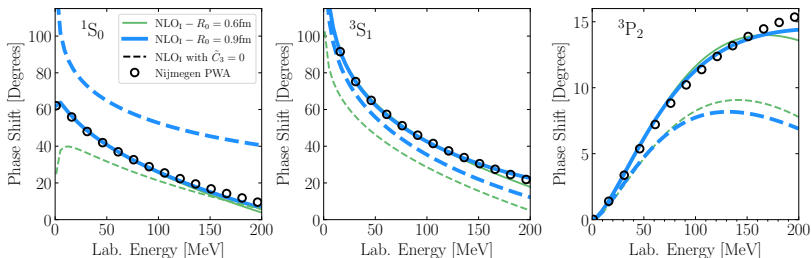


Summary

- Extend QMC perturbation theory formalism to handle non-local operators for realistic nuclear interactions
- Successfully constrained non-local operator to treat perturbatively for hard-cutoff interactions
- Paves the way for continuum AFDMC calculations of light nuclei and the neutron matter EOS at $N^3\text{LO}$

Thank you for your attention!

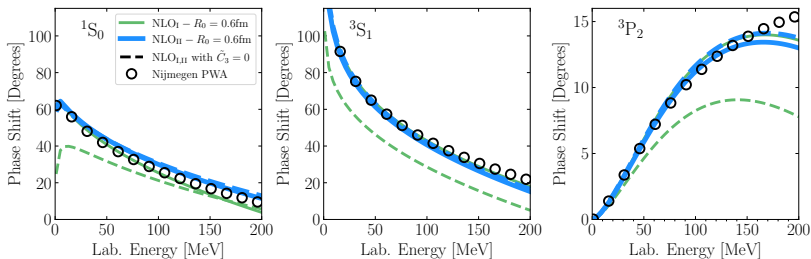
Phase Shifts with and without the nonlocal operator



- Missing physics at the two-body level, but add it perturbatively at the many-body level

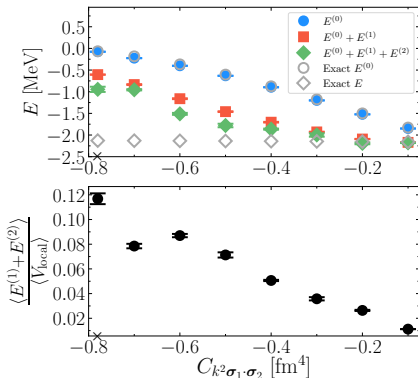
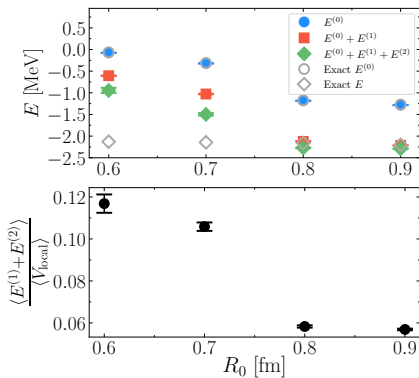
Phase Shifts with and without the nonlocal operator

- We can look at the phase shifts for our “constrained” interaction



- We can see at the two-body level that we are missing much less of the physics

Measure of Perturbativeness



Spin / Isospin Complications

DMC is very good for central interactions

$$e^{-\sum_{i<j} v(\mathbf{r}_{ij})\tau}$$

How do we handle a propagator with spin/isospin degrees of freedom?

$$e^{-\sum_{i<j} [v_1(\mathbf{r}_{ij})\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 + v_2(\mathbf{r}_{ij})\boldsymbol{\tau}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 + \dots]\tau}$$

The spin-spin term is equivalent to a Majorana exchange operator,

$$\boldsymbol{\sigma}_1 \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}_2 = 2P_{12}^{\sigma} - 1$$

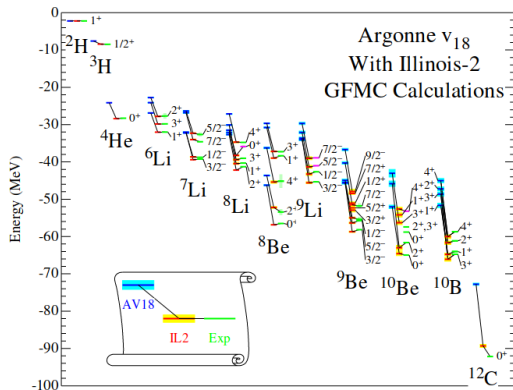
Green's Function Monte Carlo

- Explicitly sum over all spin/isospin states

$$|\Phi\rangle = \begin{pmatrix} a_{\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow} \\ a_{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\uparrow\downarrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow} \end{pmatrix} \quad \sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2 |\Phi\rangle = \begin{pmatrix} a_{\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\uparrow\uparrow\downarrow} \\ 2a_{\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow} - a_{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow} \\ 2a_{\downarrow\uparrow\downarrow} - a_{\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow} \\ 2a_{\uparrow\downarrow\uparrow} - a_{\downarrow\uparrow\uparrow} \\ 2a_{\uparrow\downarrow\downarrow} - a_{\downarrow\uparrow\downarrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\downarrow\uparrow} \\ a_{\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow} \end{pmatrix}$$

- Each of the $2^A \frac{A!}{Z!(A-Z)!}$ spin-isospin states must be propagated
- Limiting GFMC to $A \leq 12$

Green's Function Monte Carlo



S. Pieper, R.B. Wiringa,
Annu. Rev. Nucl. Part. Sci. **51** (2001)

- GFMC is an exact calculation
- Limited to $A \leq 12$
- Still used to study electroweak observables,
G.B. King and S. Pastore,
Annu. Rev. Nucl. Part. Sci. **74**
(2024)
- and few-body nuclear reactions
J.E. Lynn, I. Tews, J. Carlson, *et. al*,
Phys. Rev. Lett., **116** (2016)

Auxiliary Field Diffusion Monte Carlo

- Instead of summing over all spin-isospin states, we can sample them
- Particles can be described by single-nucleon spinors

$$|S_i\rangle = a_i |p \uparrow\rangle + b_i |p \downarrow\rangle + c_i |n \uparrow\rangle + d_i |n \downarrow\rangle$$

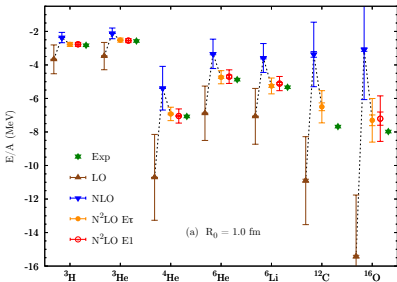
- Linearize quadratic spin/isospin ($\sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2$, etc) dependence through Hubbard-Stratonovich Transformation

$$e^{-\frac{1}{2}\lambda O^2} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int dx_e e^{-\frac{x_e^2}{2} + \sqrt{-\lambda} x_e O}$$

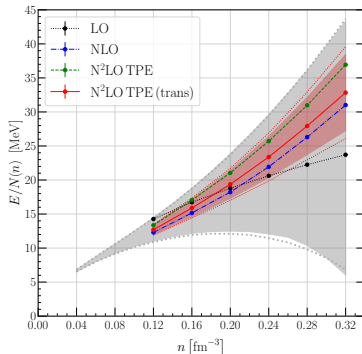
- We have traded two body $\sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2$ type interactions for single particles interacting with external auxiliary fields x

Auxiliary Field Diffusion Monte Carlo

- Trade off in precision due to sampling auxiliary fields
- Extend calculations to $A \leq 18$ as well as dense matter



D. Lonardonì, S. Gandolfi, J.E. Lynn, *et. al*
Phys. Rev. C **97** (2018)



I. Tews, R. Somasundaram, *et. al*
arXiv:2407.08979 (2024)

Practically speaking

$$I(\mathcal{T}) = \int_0^{\mathcal{T}} d\tau \langle \psi_0 | V' e^{-[H_0 - E_0]\tau} V' | \psi_0 \rangle \longrightarrow I \approx \frac{\sum_i^{\mathcal{N}} w_i V'(\mathbf{R}_i) V'(\mathbf{R}'_i)}{\sum_i^{\mathcal{N}} w_i}$$

